LESSON 10

# Für Elise

Beethoven wrote it in 1810 for a mystery Elise: the most famous piano piece in the world.

**LISTEN FIRST**
Scan the code: listen once, then hum along.

**THE WOW MOMENT**
☆ **The most famous piano piece in the world:** play the first line to anyone, anywhere, and they will know it.

## 1 Meet the song

Listen, pointing to each note. No words this time: hum it. Then play it, hands apart, then together.

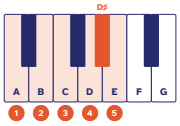



- [ ] Listened and pointed
- [ ] Hummed the famous line
- [ ] Played it with both hands

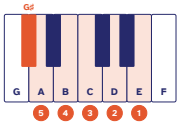
# 2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

RIGHT HAND · A POSITION




LEFT HAND · AN OCTAVE LOWER




NEW IN THIS SONG

**The A position:** both hands on A. **D♯** is D's best friend, the black key to its right; the right thumb dips to **G♯**. **3/4:** three beats a bar.

## THE RHYTHM

Count ONE two three. Clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey, open your hands on a rest.

THE TIME

$\frac{3}{4}$

**Top 3:** three beats in every bar: ONE two three.
**Bottom 4:** a crotchet is one beat.

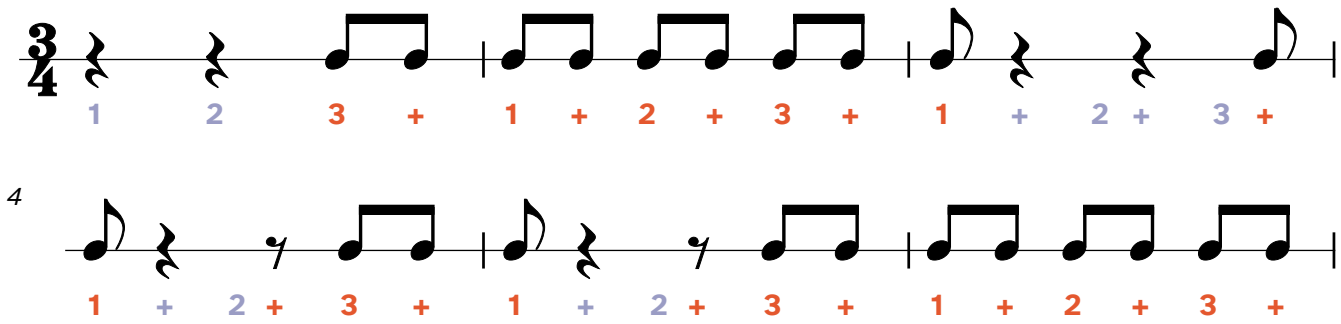
THE NOTES

**two quavers: run-ning**
1 beat

**crotchet: walk**
1 beat

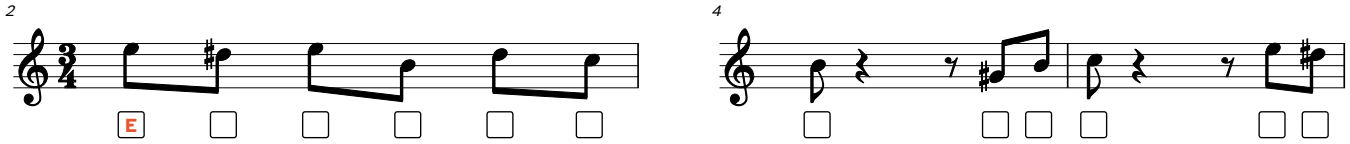
**crotchet rest: wait**
1 beat

**dotted minim: hold-2-3**
3 beats




## THE NOTES

Write the letter under each note of the famous line; D♯ is D with its sharp.




SPOT THE MISTAKE Your teacher plays D instead of D♯. Put up your hand: the spooky colour is gone. Then the other way: G instead of G♯.

- [ ] **Counted in three**
- [ ] **Clapped it**
- [ ] **Wrote the letters**
- [ ] **Spotted the mistake**

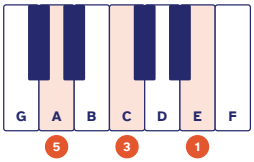
# 3 Your first lead sheet

A lead sheet: the tune on top, only chord names below. Play the roots from the names.

## MEET THE ROOTS

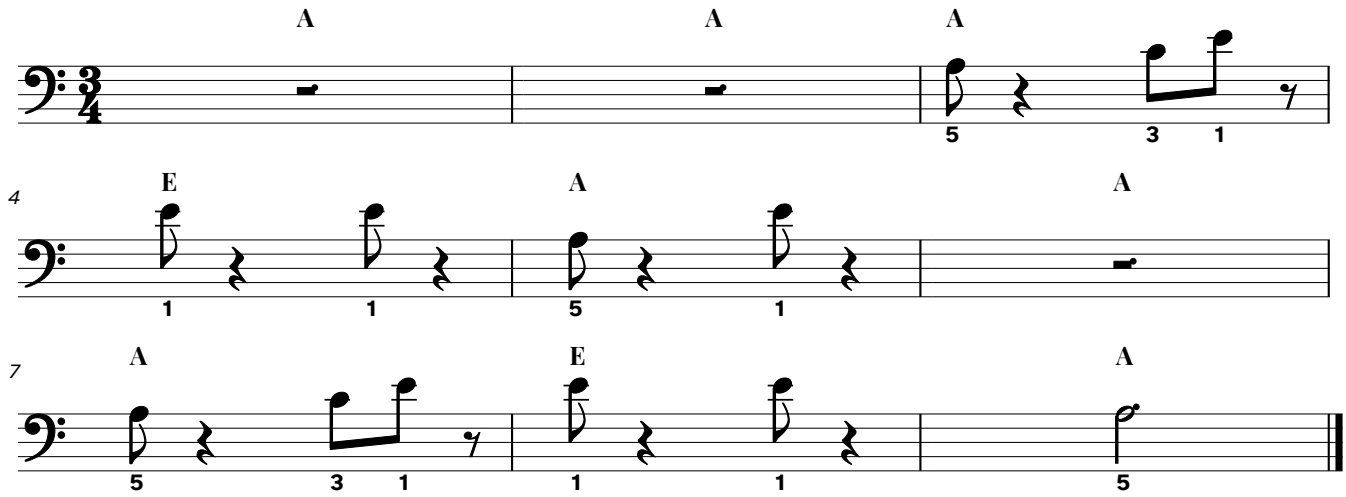
Two roots: A (left hand 5) and E (left thumb). Am is A minor, the sad A chord; E pulls back to A.

LEFT HAND · A POSITION, 5 ON A




## THE LEFT HAND ON ITS OWN

Its part, with the names above: A for Am, E for E, and the C E that climbs in the gaps.




## PLAY FROM THE NAMES

Only the names now. Hold each bar's root (A or E) while your teacher or the band plays the tune.

| Am | Am | E | Am | Am | Am | E | Am |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|

### 4 · CHECK

☐ I can count in three ☐ I can find D♯ and G♯ ☐ I can play the famous line

**I can play it: colour a step each time you climb**

| | Slowly | Steady | With the band | Fast |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| From the notes | | | | |
| From the names | | | | |

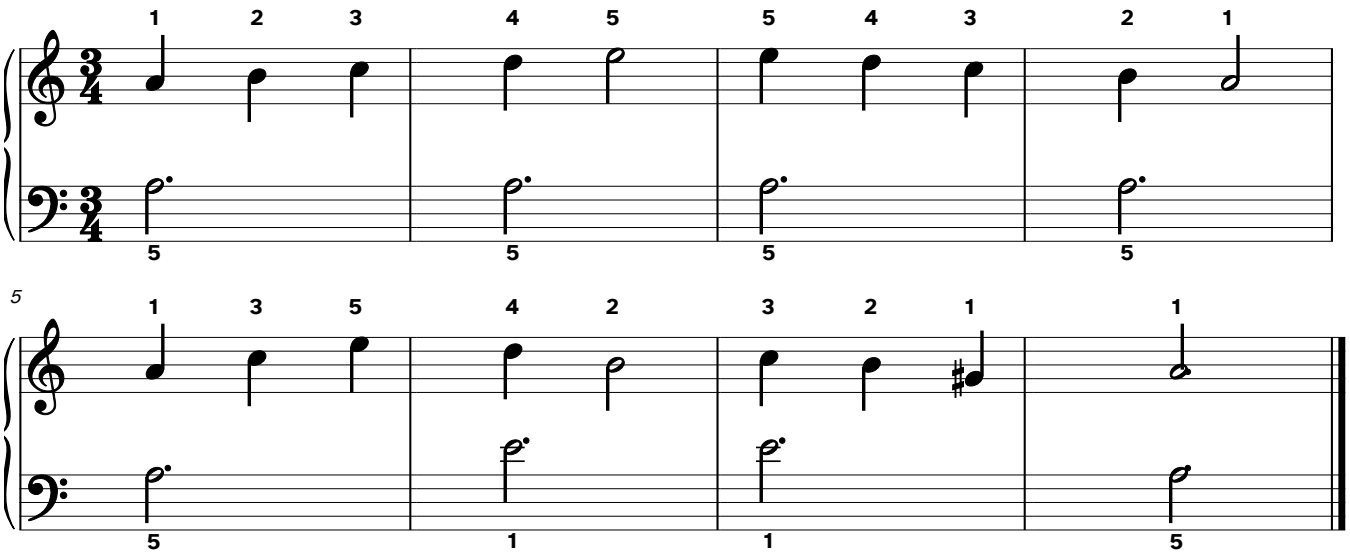
TEACHER ☐ Pass ☐ Not yet

# + More to play

Two more in three-time: a ghost walk in the A position, and a waltz back home in C.

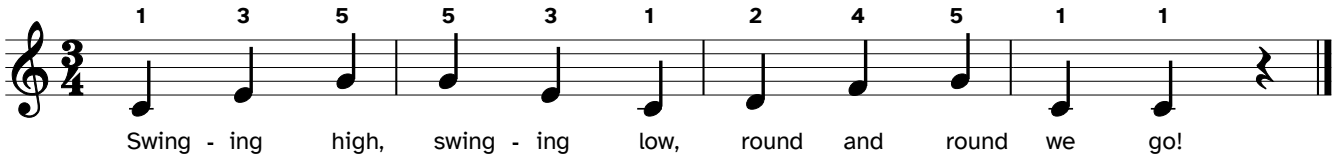
## GHOST WALK

The A position, hands together: the right hand walks the five keys while the left hand holds its root. Spooky, soft, smooth.




## SWING SONG

A waltz for the C position: three beats in a bar, lean on ONE, like a swing.




## MAKE IT YOURS

Pick one and play the whole piece that way. Can your teacher guess which?

- ☐ **Ghostly: very soft, the D♯ a whisper**
- ☐ **From the names: your teacher plays the tune, you play the roots A and E**
- ☐ **Swapped: the left hand plays the famous line an octave lower**

## 5 MINUTES AT HOME

1. Listen to the piece once
2. Line 1, the famous bit, three times
3. Both hands, slowly
4. The roots from the names, with the band

☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S

☐ **Played Ghost Walk** ☐ **Played Swing Song**